

MIDTERM

1-4

MIDTERM CRAM SHEET

Channel Theory + LU · LI · ST · SP · HT · SI

155 points cumulative · Weeks 1-4 · Midterm covers this material

CHANNELS

6 channels, 155 pts
Circadian clock order

SPECIAL PTS

Yuan/Luo/Xi-Cleft
Front-Mu/Back-Shu/He-Sea

HIGH-YIELD

Forbidden pregnancy
Commonly confused pairs

6 channels, color-coded by element

LU

Metal

LI

Metal

ST

Earth

SP

Earth

HT

Fire

SI

Fire

+ circadian clock · confluent/command points · special-point category legend · forbidden-pregnancy flags

CHANNEL THEORY – CORE RULES

Nomenclature (3 parts)

Hand/Foot (location) + Yin/Yang (medial/lateral, nature) + Zang/Fu (pertaining organ, function)

Qi circulation direction

Hand Yin: chest -> hand | Hand Yang: hand -> head | Foot Yang: head -> foot | Foot Yin: foot -> abdomen/chest

Hand Yin / Hand Yang meet

At the fingers (e.g. LU7 -> LI1 branch meets at index finger)

12 Primary Meridians

3 Hand Yin + 3 Hand Yang + 3 Foot Yin + 3 Foot Yang = 12. Plus 8 Extraordinary Vessels, 15 Luo-connecting, divergent + sinew + cutaneous channels.

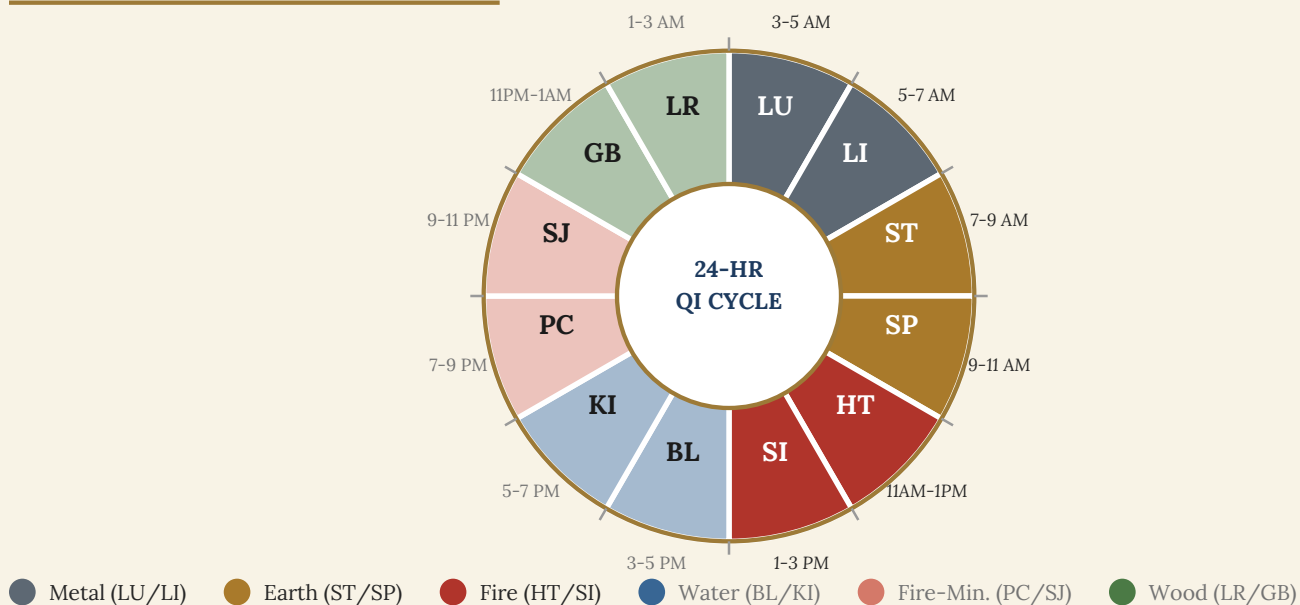
Zang-Fu pairing logic

Each Yin (zang) channel pairs with one Yang (fu) channel; paired channels treat each other's organ symptoms (e.g. LU constipation -> use LI points).

Hand Yang distribution

Anterior = Yangming, Middle = Shaoyang, Posterior = Taiyang (also applies conceptually to Foot Yang).

CIRCADIAN CLOCK – 24-HOUR QI CYCLE



Paired organs sit in adjacent clock slots (LU/LI, ST/SP, HT/SI) – the Qi circulation chain flows straight from one into the next. Muted wedges (BL/KI/PC/SJ/GB/LR) are covered in later weeks.

6 CHANNELS AT A GLANCE

Ch	Full name	Type	Element	Pts	Paired	Front-Mu	Back-Shu
LU	Hand Taiyin	Yin	Metal	11	LI	LU1	BL13
LI	Hand Yangming	Yang	Metal	20	LU	ST25	BL25
ST	Foot Yangming	Yang	Earth	45	SP	CV12	BL21
SP	Foot Taiyin	Yin	Earth	21	ST	LR13	BL20
HT	Hand Shaoyin	Yin	Fire	9	SI	CV14	BL15
SI	Hand Taiyang	Yang	Fire	19	HT	CV4	BL27

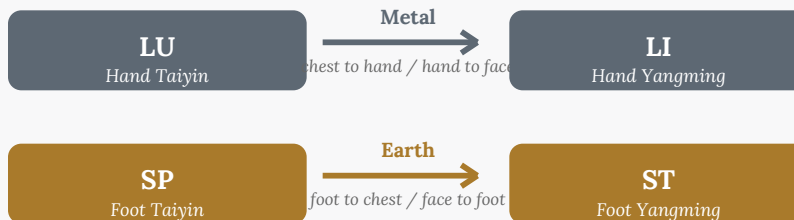
TAIYIN, YANGMING, SHAOYIN, TAIYANG, JUEYIN, SHAOYANG

The 3 circuits from Week 1, and where Weeks 1-4 sit inside the full 12-channel picture.

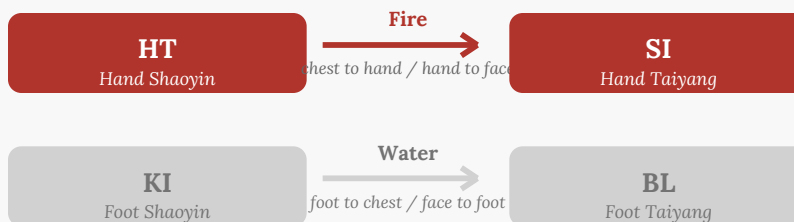
Posterior Circuit = also called Inner Circuit

Dr. Zhang's slides use "Anterior/Posterior/Middle Circuit" as the primary names, but the Posterior Circuit has also been labeled "Inner Circuit" on earlier slide versions – both terms may come up verbally or on the exam, so know both.

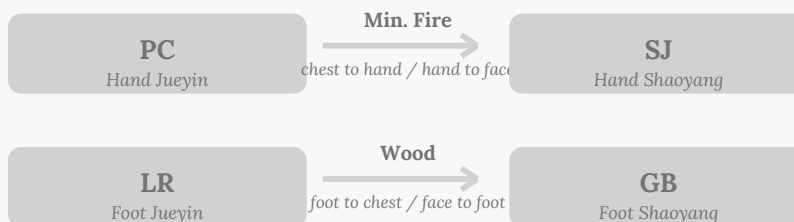
ANTERIOR CIRCUIT (Taiyin / Yangming) – fully covered, Weeks 1-4



POSTERIOR CIRCUIT (Shaoyin / Taiyang) – half covered: HT/SI now, BL/KI Week 5



MIDDLE CIRCUIT (Jueyin / Shaoyang) – not yet covered, Week 6



WHAT EACH NAME MEANS

Term	Literal meaning	Circuit	Hand/Foot organs
Taiyin	Greater Yin	Anterior	LU / SP
Yangming	Yang Brightness	Anterior	LI / ST
Shaoyin	Lesser Yin	Posterior	HT / KI
Taiyang	Greater Yang	Posterior	SI / BL
Jueyin	Terminal / Reverting Yin	Middle	PC / LR
Shaoyang	Lesser Yang	Middle	SJ / GB

SPECIAL POINT CATEGORIES

What each category means, and where you've already seen it in Weeks 1-4.

The Five Shu Points — Jing-Well through He-Sea below — are their own named group per Dr. Zhang's slides.

Category	What it means	Examples (Wk 1-4)
Jing-Well	"Where it emerges" — distal-most point (fingertip/toenail); channel's start/end; first aid, clears heat, relieves pain	LU11, HT9, LI1, ST45, SP1, SI1
Ying-Spring	"Where it flows" — before the MCP/MTP joint; treats feverish diseases, heat-related disorders	LU10, LI2, ST44, SP2, HT8, SI2
Shu-Stream	"Where it pours" — after the MCP/MTP joint; treats heaviness in the body, joint pain, pain syndromes	LU9(Yuan), LI3, ST43, SP3(Yuan), HT7(Yuan), SI3(Confluent)
Jing-River	"Where it travels" — on the forearm/lower leg; treats externally contracted disease (colds, flu), cough, asthma	LU8, LI5, ST41, SP5, HT4, SI5
He-Sea	"Where it enters" — near elbow/knee joints; where Qi enters deepest; treats organ-level / six Fu-organ disorders	LU5, LI11, ST36, SP9, HT3, SI8
Yuan-Source	Reflects and regulates the organ's original Qi; primary diagnostic + treatment point for that organ	LU9, LI4, ST42, SP3, HT7, SI4
Luo-Connecting	Links each paired Yin/Yang channel; treats symptoms of both channels in the pair	LU7, LI6, ST40, SP4, HT5, SI7
Xi-Cleft	Accumulation point; treats acute pain, bleeding, or crisis flare of that channel	LU6, LI7, ST34, SP8, HT6, SI6
Front-Mu	Diagnostic/treatment point on the chest or abdomen for the paired organ	LU1, ST25(LI), CV12(ST), LR13(SP), CV14(HT), CV4(SI)
Back-Shu	Diagnostic/treatment point on the back for the paired organ	BL13(LU), BL25(LI), BL21(ST), BL20(SP), BL15(HT), BL27(SI)
Confluent	Opens one of the 8 Extraordinary Vessels	LU7(Ren Mai), SP4(Chong Mai), SI3(Du Mai)
Command	Broad regional treatment authority over a body area	LU7(head/neck), LI4(face/mouth), ST36(abdomen)

Study tip

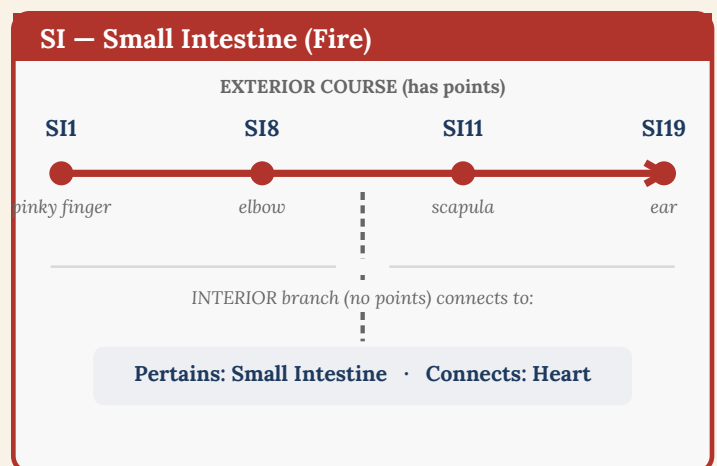
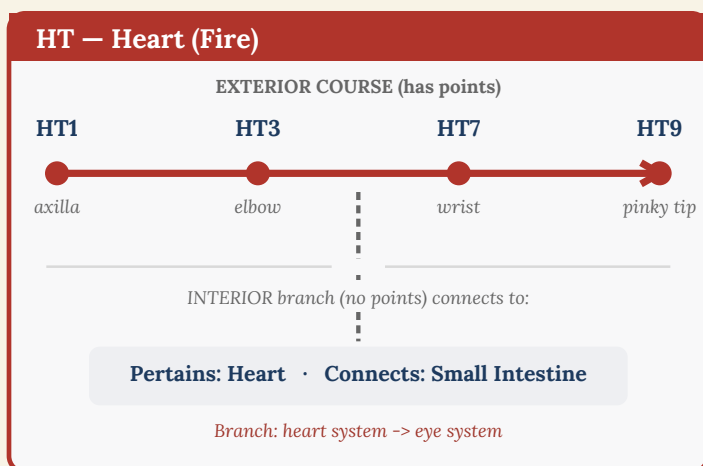
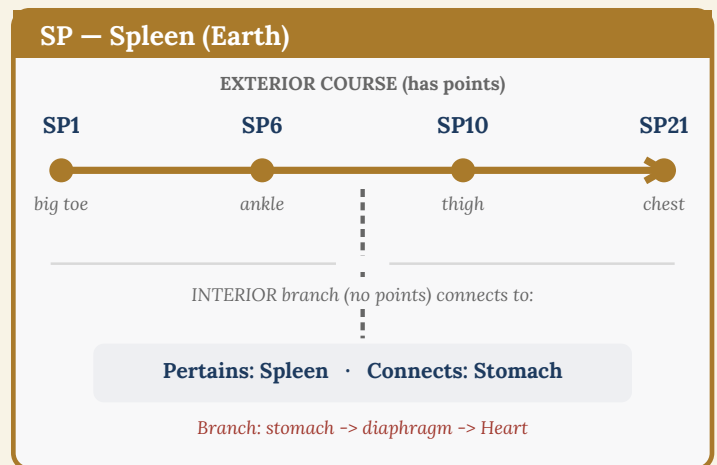
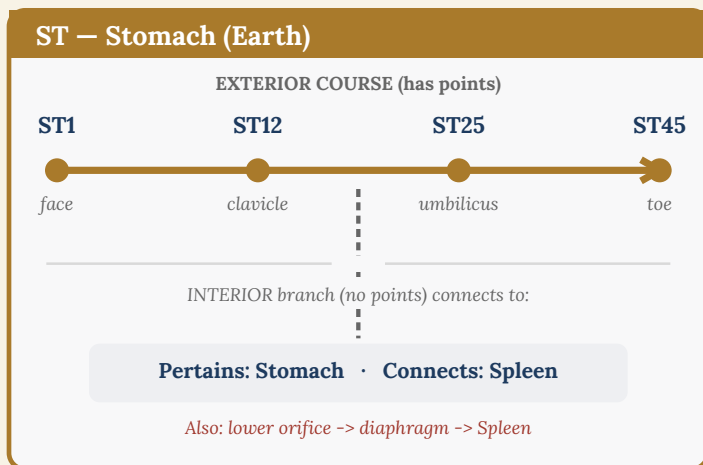
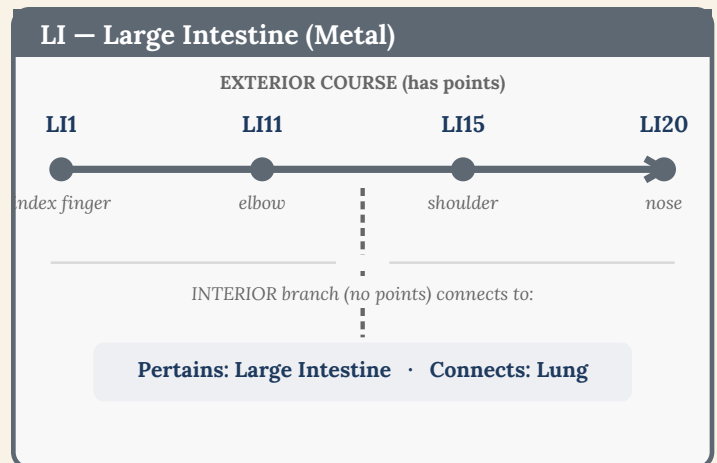
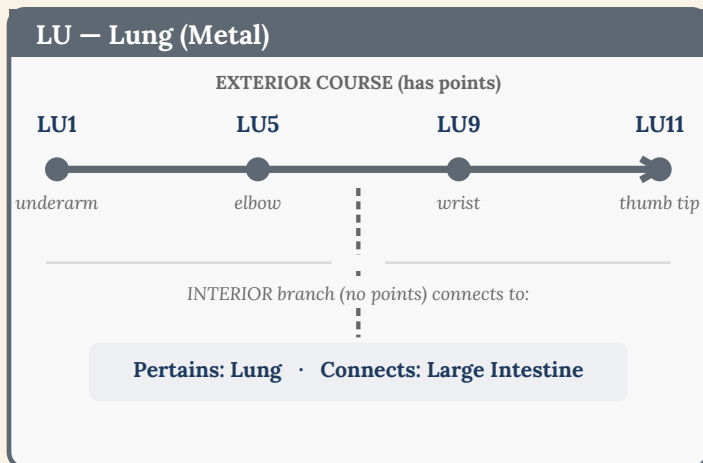
Front-Mu and Back-Shu points are especially high-yield for the midterm since they cross-reference organs you haven't studied yet (e.g. SP's Front-Mu is LR13, LU/LI/ST/SP/HT/SI's Back-Shu points are all on BL) — know the pairing, not just the point code.

Looking ahead

All 6 channels' Back-Shu points live on the Bladder channel in spinal order (BL13 LU, BL15 HT, BL18 LR, BL20 SP, BL21 ST, BL25 LI, BL27 SI) — you'll meet BL properly in Week 5, but recognizing this row now makes that channel far easier to learn.

WHERE THE POINTS ARE vs. WHERE THE CHANNEL JUST CONNECTS

Every channel has an EXTERIOR course (solid line) running along the limb/trunk/face where the acupuncture points actually sit, and an INTERIOR branch (dashed line) that dives into the body to reach the Zang-Fu organs – the interior branch has no points on it.



LU – Lung

Hand Taiyin · Yin · Metal · Peak 3-5AM · Paired: LI · 11 pts

Category	Point	Notes
Jing-Well	LU11	
Ying-Spring	LU10	
Shu-Stream	LU9	also Yuan-Source
Jing-River	LU8	
He-Sea	LU5	clears heat, descends Qi
Luo	LU7	also Confluent + Command
Xi-Cleft	LU6	
Front-Mu	LU1	chest fullness, grief
Back-Shu	BL13	
Confluent	LU7	opens Ren Mai
Command	LU7	head/neck

Clinical Pearls

LU7: command for head/neck; opens Ren Mai; #1 point for exterior wind
 LU9: Yuan-source; influential for vessels; tonifies Lung Qi and Yin
 LU5: He-Sea; clears heat, descends Qi; treats cough/asthma/hemoptysis
 LU1: Front-Mu; chest fullness, grief, chronic cough

LI – Large Intestine

Hand Yangming · Yang · Metal · Peak 5-7AM · Paired: LU · 20 pts

Category	Point	Notes
Jing-Well	LI1	
Ying-Spring	LI2	
Shu-Stream	LI3	
Jing-River	LI5	
He-Sea	LI11	clears heat in blood
Yuan-Source	LI4	FORBIDDEN in pregnancy
Luo	LI6	
Xi-Cleft	LI7	
Front-Mu	ST25	of Large Intestine
Back-Shu	BL25	
Command	LI4	face/mouth

Clinical Pearls

LI4: command for face/mouth; clears wind-heat; FORBIDDEN in pregnancy
 LI11: He-Sea; clears heat in blood; skin disorders, high fever
 LI20: local for nasal disorders; reunion point with ST channel
 LI10: empirical for GI complaints; shoulder/arm pain

ST – Stomach

Foot Yangming · Yang · Earth · Peak 7-9AM · Paired: SP · 45 pts

Category	Point	Notes
Jing-Well	ST45	
Ying-Spring	ST44	clears Yangming heat
Shu-Stream	ST43	
Jing-River	ST41	
He-Sea	ST36	command abdomen, most important tonic pt
Yuan-Source	ST42	
Luo	ST40	resolves phlegm-dampness anywhere
Xi-Cleft	ST34	
Front-Mu	CV12	
Back-Shu	BL21	
Command	ST36	abdomen
Lower He-Sea	ST37	of Large Intestine

Clinical Pearls

ST36: command for abdomen; tonifies Qi and Blood; most important tonic point
 ST40: Luo; resolves phlegm-dampness anywhere in the body
 ST25: Front-Mu of LI; regulates intestines, transforms stagnation
 ST44: clears Yangming heat; toothache, epistaxis, fever

SP – Spleen

Foot Taiyin · Yin · Earth · Peak 9-11AM · Paired: ST · 21 pts

Category	Point	Notes
Jing-Well	SP1	
Ying-Spring	SP2	
Shu-Stream	SP3	also Yuan-Source
Jing-River	SP5	
He-Sea	SP9	resolves dampness
Luo	SP4	also Confluent (Chong Mai)
Xi-Cleft	SP8	
Front-Mu	LR13	
Back-Shu	BL20	
Confluent	SP4	opens Chong Mai
Sea of Blood	SP10	cools blood, skin/menstrual

Clinical Pearls

SP6: crossing of 3 Yin channels; regulates menstruation, calms mind; FORBIDDEN in pregnancy
 SP9: He-Sea; resolves dampness; edema, diarrhea, knee pain
 SP10: Sea of Blood; cools blood; skin disorders, irregular menstruation
 SP4: Luo + Confluent (Chong Mai); GI disorders, menstrual issues

❏ **FORBIDDEN IN PREGNANCY (Wk 1-4): LI4, SP6**

HT — Heart

Hand Shaoyin · Yin · Fire · Peak 11AM-1PM · Paired: SI · 9 pts

Category	Point	Notes
Jing-Well	HT9	
Ying-Spring	HT8	clears heart fire
Shu-Stream	HT7	also Yuan-Source
Jing-River	HT4	
He-Sea	HT3	clears heart fire, fear/arm pain
Luo	HT5	
Xi-Cleft	HT6	night sweats, acute heart pain
Front-Mu	CV14	
Back-Shu	BL15	

Clinical Pearls

HT7: Yuan-source; calms shen; insomnia, anxiety, palpitations
 HT3: He-Sea; clears heart fire; fear, arm pain
 HT6: Xi-Cleft; night sweats, acute heart pain
 HT8: Ying-Spring; clears heart fire; oral ulcers, urinary urgency

SI — Small Intestine

Hand Taiyang · Yang · Fire · Peak 1-3PM · Paired: HT · 19 pts

Category	Point	Notes
Jing-Well	SI1	
Ying-Spring	SI2	
Shu-Stream	SI3	also Confluent
Jing-River	SI5	
He-Sea	SI8	
Yuan-Source	SI4	wrist/finger pain, febrile disease
Luo	SI7	
Xi-Cleft	SI6	
Front-Mu	CV4	
Back-Shu	BL27	
Confluent	SI3	opens Du Mai

Clinical Pearls

SI3: confluent (Du Mai); neck/spine disorders; opens governing vessel
 SI11: most important local point for frozen shoulder
 SI19: local point for tinnitus and deafness
 SI4: Yuan-source; wrist and finger pain; febrile diseases

COMMONLY CONFUSED / HIGH-YIELD PAIRS

LU7 vs LI4 — both treat face/head; LU7 = command head/neck + opens Ren Mai; LI4 = command face/mouth, FORBIDDEN in pregnancy
 ST36 vs SP6 — both abdominal; ST36 = command abdomen, tonifies Qi/Blood; SP6 = 3-Yin crossing, FORBIDDEN in pregnancy
 SI3 vs LI4 — both treat head/neck; SI3 = confluent opens Du Mai (spine); LI4 = command face/mouth